

← Home日本語한국어English

AI Customer Acquisition Services: Global Trends and Japan-Korea Business Model Analysis

Agentic Marketing, Hyper-Personalization, and the LLMO Era of Customer Acquisition

Report Date: May 26, 2026 | Standard Report (5-8 pages)

Top 5 Trends

1. The Rise of Agentic Marketing

Status: In 2026, AI-driven customer acquisition has moved beyond using generative AI to speed up individual tasks. Marketers now delegate full work units—decision and execution—to AI agents, while humans focus on judgment and editing. Salesforce frames the shift as marketers becoming "strategic directors who orchestrate AI agents." Real implementations are visible across SoftBank logistics (40% delivery efficiency gain in Japan) and Hyundai Motors / telecom AICCs in Korea.

Core Capabilities

- **Autonomous campaigns:** Agents handle segmentation, content generation, distribution, and optimization end-to-end
- **Lead scoring:** Real-time prioritization based on behavioral data (HubSpot Breeze, Salesforce Einstein)
- **Delegated decisions:** Humans set guardrails; agents execute

Market Data

- **AI customer service market:** \$15.12B in 2026 → \$47.82B by 2030 (25.8% CAGR)
- **Routine automation:** 80% of interactions handled by AI in 2026 (Gartner)
- **ROI:** \$3.50 returned per \$1 invested in AI customer service
- **Cost reduction:** \$80B in contact-center labor savings projected for 2026

Related Links:

[Salesforce Einstein](#) | [HubSpot Breeze](#) | [MarketsandMarkets Report](#)

Credibility Assessment:

8.5/10

Strengths: Authoritative sources (MarketsandMarkets, Gartner), specific ROI/CAGR figures

Weaknesses: Industry-by-industry variation in the 80% automation figure needs deeper analysis

Outlook: 2026–2027 marks the inflection point where "AI agent orchestration capability" becomes a core marketing KPI. Only organizations pairing tool adoption with process redesign and governance will see real results.

2. Hyper-Personalization: The Starbucks DeepBrew Model Spreads

Status: Beyond simple recommendations, real-time 1-to-1 promotions combining purchase history, preference, location, time, and weather have become the norm. Starbucks's proprietary DeepBrew AI platform delivers hyper-personalized offers to tens of millions; Korean coffee chains and Japanese beauty / retail brands are rapidly replicating the pattern.

Japan Cases

- **Salon group Lond:** LINE mini-app "Saloriza" rollout; some stores see 40% of bookings via LINE
- **Beauty Salon Be+ (Tsukuba):** Acquired 250+ repeat customers via LINE auto-reply
- **Restaurants:** AI congestion-forecast calendars on websites distribute visit timing

Korea Cases

- **Starbucks Korea:** Mobile Order data + AI recommendations lift average ticket size
- **KakaoTalk Channel:** AlimTalk-based segment campaigns, integrated review management for Musinsa / Coupang
- **Naver SmartStore:** Tools like "Search Doogam" optimize product names and hashtags for higher visibility

Related Links:

[Starbucks DeepBrew](#) | [KakaoTalk Channel](#) | [LINE CLOVA Beauty Cases](#)

Credibility Assessment:

8.0/10

Strengths: Named real-world cases in both countries (Lond, Be+, Starbucks), with concrete figures (40%, 250)

Weaknesses: Quantitative revenue attribution for DeepBrew is missing

Outlook: Hyper-personalization is no longer a differentiator—it's table stakes. The next battleground is integrating offline behavior data + payment data + location data.

3. The LLMO/AIO Era: ChatGPT Atlas, Perplexity, and Google AI Mode as New Traffic Channels

Status: AI browsers and AI search engines—ChatGPT Atlas, Perplexity Comet, Google AI Overview—have replaced large swaths of SEO traffic. The question shifted from "How do we get noticed?" to "How do we rank in the AI's recommendation order?" (LLMO: LLM Optimization). Japan already has 21 specialized LLMO agencies on the market.

Zero-Click Environment Shifts

- **Traffic decline:** SERP CTR falls; citation inside AI summaries becomes key
- **Structured data:** Schema.org, FAQ markup, and trust signals drive citation odds
- **Brand mentions:** Third-party media mentions weight AI recommendation rankings

LLMO Response Strategy

- **Content redesign:** Clear definitions, statistics, and citation-friendly formats
- **Japan LLMO market:** 2026 comparison guides list 21 specialized agencies
- **Korea:** Needs to address Naver Cue while optimizing for ChatGPT citations

Related Links:

[Perplexity](#) | [ChatGPT Atlas](#) | [Google AI Overview](#)

Credibility Assessment:

7.5/10

Strengths: Concrete market data such as the 21 LLMO agencies in Japan

Weaknesses: Quantitative LLMO measurement standards are still emerging

Outlook: 30–40% of the SEO agency market is likely to pivot to LLMO services within two years; Korea's local LLMO market should mature in H2 2026.

4. Predictive Lead Scoring & ABM Become the Standard

Status: In B2B, ABM (Account-Based Marketing) using anonymous intent data from 6sense, Demandbase, Bombora, and Cognism has become the default for identifying in-market accounts. 6sense was named a Forrester Leader in B2B Revenue Marketing 2026, while HubSpot and Salesforce have embedded predictive scoring into their CRMs, lowering entry barriers.

Core Technology

- **Intent data:** Behavioral signals aggregated from review sites (G2, TrustRadius)
- **Predictive scoring:** Models trained on past won deals applied to new leads

- **Buying-group insight:** Mapping the whole buying committee, not a single contact

Adoption in Japan & Korea

- **Japan:** Marketo / HubSpot adoption led by SaaS companies; ICT Research projects 35.53M generative-AI users by end of 2026
- **Korea:** Kakao Enterprise and Samsung SDS B2B teams expanding Salesforce Einstein use
- **Shared gap:** Many mid-market firms in both countries still have weak first-party data

Related Links:

[6sense](#) | [Demandbase](#) | [Cognism](#)

Credibility Assessment:

8.5/10

Strengths: Authoritative sources (Forrester evaluation, ICT Research user counts)

Weaknesses: Korea B2B adoption statistics rely on a small sample

Outlook: ABM is no longer the domain of global SaaS alone. By 2027, more than 30% of mid-market B2B firms in Japan and Korea will likely embed predictive scoring into their sales process.

5. Vertical AI Acquisition SaaS Explodes Across Beauty, Restaurants, and E-Commerce

Status: Alongside horizontal marketing platforms, industry-specific AI customer acquisition SaaS is exploding in Japan and Korea simultaneously. Japan's wave centers on LINE-ecosystem solutions for beauty and restaurants (Saloriza, AI-BOUZ, CAT.AI); Korea's wave runs on Kakao / Naver-ecosystem e-commerce tooling (Search Doogam, ALF chatbot, Zentoo recommendations).

Japan Vertical SaaS

- **Saloriza (LINE mini-app):** Unifies salon bookings and CRM; external-site dependency dropped 80%→50%
- **CAT.AI:** AI customer-facing service for retail, F&B, and lodging (incl. phone auto-reply)
- **Geniee AI:** Crowd forecasting + menu recommendations for restaurants
- **HOTPEPPER Beauty + AI:** Recruit's salon-matching engine

Korea Vertical SaaS

- **Search Doogam:** AI-driven product-name and keyword optimization for SmartStore
- **ALF chatbot:** Godomall app store; vehicle-parts matching by car model
- **Zentoo:** Product-recommendation chatbot widely deployed across fashion / lifestyle e-commerce
- **Saltlux:** Korean-LLM-based chatbot, strong in public sector and finance

Related Links:

[Saloriza](#) | [CAT.AI](#) | [Saltlux](#) | [NAVER CLOVA Chatbot](#)

Credibility Assessment:

8.0/10

Strengths: Clear mapping of named services and features across both countries

Weaknesses: Per-SaaS customer-count and revenue data could be strengthened

Outlook: Both countries lean heavily on messenger platforms (LINE, KakaoTalk), making vertical SaaS easy to launch but vulnerable to platform-policy changes. Multi-channel diversification (Instagram DM, WhatsApp, own apps) is the next strategic priority.

Competitive Landscape

4-Tier Market Structure

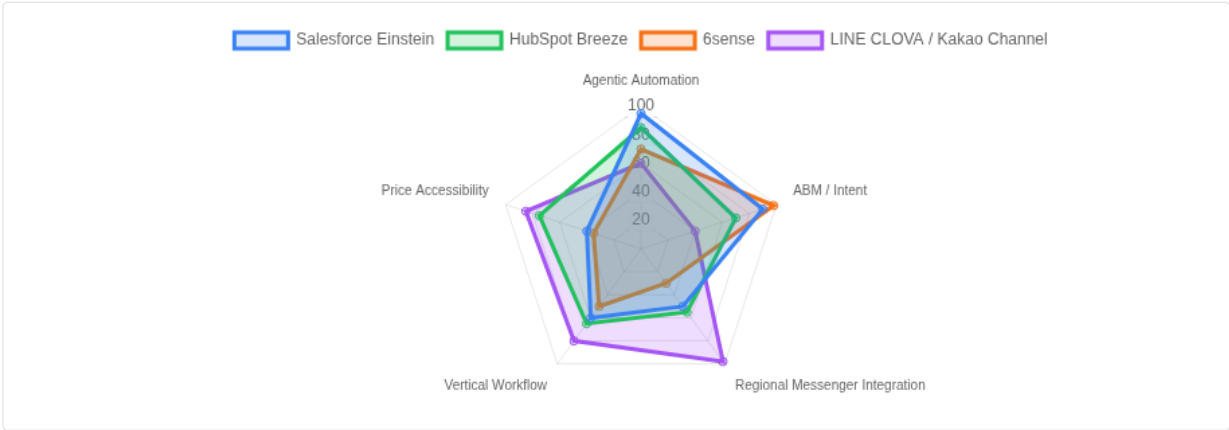
The AI customer acquisition market splits clearly into four tiers, from global integrated platforms to local messenger-based vertical SaaS.

Tier	Representative Players	Core Value	Target Customers
Tier 1: Global Integrated Marketing Cloud	Salesforce Einstein, HubSpot Breeze, Adobe Sensei	Full-funnel integration, predictive scoring, agentic automation	Enterprises and global B2B
Tier 2: Intent / ABM Specialists	6sense, Demandbase, Bombora, Cognism	Anonymous intent detection, buying-group mapping	Mid-to-large B2B SaaS
Tier 3: Regional Messenger / Search Platforms	LINE CLOVA, Kakao Channel, NAVER CLOVA, WeChat	Local-infrastructure-based chatbot and notification marketing	Asian SMB to enterprise
Tier 4: Vertical AI Acquisition SaaS	Saloriza, CAT.AI, Search Doogam, ALF, Zentoo, Saltlux	Industry-specific workflows (beauty, F&B, e-commerce)	SMB and small merchants

Key Market Dynamics

- **Market consolidation:** Tier 1 players are embedding ABM features and encroaching on Tier 2 territory
- **Regional divergence:** Japan and Korea show 2x stronger Tier 3 influence than global averages due to messenger lock-in
- **Vertical explosion:** Lower LLM entry barriers spawn new Tier 4 SaaS every 6–12 months
- **LLMO new market:** Japan has 21 specialized agencies already; Korea is expected to mature in H2 2026
- **Workforce reset:** AI is cutting 20–30% of CS staff—but 50% of those companies will re-hire in 2027 (role redesign matters more than replacement)

Platform Capability Comparison (Radar Chart)



Application Ideas

Approaches observed across the market that organizations might explore.

- Japan-Korea SMB launch package** — Bundle LINE mini-apps (Saloriza model) with Kakao Channel automation for beauty / F&B SMBs as a monthly subscription
- LLMO consulting + content refactor** — A 90-day program that restructures existing SEO assets to be citation-friendly for ChatGPT and Perplexity
- Lightweight ABM stack for mid-market B2B** — HubSpot Breeze + Cognism free tier delivers most of 6sense's core value at roughly 1/5 the cost

Executive Summary

Key Insights

- **Paradigm shift:** Moving from "AI as a tool" to "agents that run campaigns" — 2026–2027 is the inflection point
- **Japan-Korea convergence:** Messenger-platform-dependent business models (LINE, KakaoTalk) are accelerating faster than global counterparts
- **LLMO new market:** Japan already hosts 21 specialized firms; Korea's market expected to take shape in H2 2026
- **ROI proof:** Every \$1 in AI customer service returns \$3.50, with projected \$80B in contact-center labor savings in 2026
- **Workforce trap:** 50% of companies that cut staff for AI will re-hire by 2027—role redesign beats raw replacement

Selection Guide

Large global B2B → Salesforce Einstein + 6sense

Why: Full-funnel integration plus best-in-class ABM intent data

Japan / Korea mid-market SaaS → HubSpot Breeze + Cognism

Why: Agentic + ABM essentials at a moderate price point

Korean D2C / e-commerce → Kakao Channel + Naver Search Doogam + Zentoo

Why: Built on the local traffic infrastructure; leverages channel lock-in

Japan SMB (beauty / F&B) → LINE Official Account + Saloriza / CAT.AI

Why: 80%+ LINE penetration; immediate booking and CRM integration wins

Overall sentiment: Positive — Market data, real cases, and ROI all show consistent growth signals. Korean B2B ABM statistics still need further validation.

Overall Credibility Assessment

8.0/10

Overall: Data-driven report drawing on a balanced mix of global and Japan-Korea sources

Key strengths: ① Primary sources (MarketsandMarkets, Forrester, Gartner, IDC Japan) ② Named real-world cases in both countries (Lond, Be+, Starbucks Korea, Kakao, etc.) ③ Clear 4-tier market structure

Priorities for improvement: ① Strengthen Korea B2B ABM adoption statistics ② Explicitly note that LLMO measurement standards are unsettled ③ Add per-vertical-SaaS revenue and customer counts

Key Terminology

AI Customer Acquisition: Marketing activities that use AI to automate the full path from prospect discovery to conversion

Agentic Marketing: A marketing approach where AI agents autonomously design, execute, and optimize campaigns

LLMO (LLM Optimization): The discipline of optimizing content so it gets cited and recommended by LLM-based search systems like ChatGPT and Perplexity — the AI-era successor to SEO

ABM (Account-Based Marketing): A B2B strategy that aligns sales and marketing around target companies (accounts) rather than individual leads

Intent Data: Anonymous behavioral signals captured from prospects on third-party sites (reviews, searches, content)

Zero-Click Environment: A search behavior shift where AI answers directly, leaving users no need to visit external sites

References

Data collected: May 26, 2026

- [MarketsandMarkets — AI for Customer Service Market \\$47.82B by 2030](#)
- [Ringly — 45+ AI Customer Service Statistics for 2026](#)
- [Connected One — What Changed in AI Customer Acquisition in 2026](#)

- [AI Smiley — AI Trend Report 2026](#)
- [Nikkei — ICT Research Generative AI Service Survey, Feb 2026](#)
- [Salesforce Korea — The Era of Agentic Marketing](#)
- [Remember — AI Marketing Trends 2026](#)
- [LINE CLOVA — Beauty Industry AI Cases](#)
- [J-Barrel — Salon LINE Official Account 200% Acquisition Growth](#)
- [Kakao Business — KakaoTalk Channel Chatbot](#)
- [NAVER CLOVA Chatbot](#)
- [Bakuri — Top 21 LLMO Agencies in Japan 2026](#)